Set Up Development Tools

In this lesson, we'll focus on the crucial steps for setting up our development environment tailored for React. By the end of this lesson, you'll have all the necessary tools installed and ready for coding in React.

Choosing a Text Editor or IDE

For writing React code, you have the flexibility to choose any text editor or Integrated Development Environment (IDE) that you prefer.

Using TypeScript with React

A popular choice among developers is **TypeScript**, a superset of JavaScript. This language is known for being strongly typed, providing compile-time checking, and enjoying robust IDE support. It enhances the development experience, especially in larger projects. Stay tuned for detailed discussions about TypeScript in our upcoming lessons.

Essential Command Line Tools

We'll also need some command-line tools to compile code and create React apps and components. Here's what you'll need:

- **Visual Studio Code**: This free IDE supports multiple programming languages and has built-in support for TypeScript. Notable features include IntelliSense, debugging, and much more. Learn about Visual Studio Code at Code Visual Studio.
- **Node Tool**: A tool for running JavaScript code from the command line.
- **NPM (Node Package Manager)**: This tool helps in downloading new Node packages and features, functioning in a way loosely similar to MAVEN.
- **TSC (TypeScript Compiler)**: Essential for compiling TypeScript code.

Installation Instructions

Installing these tools (Visual Studio Code, Node, NPM, TSC) is a straightforward process, and we've prepared step-by-step instructions for various operating systems, including Windows, Mac, and Linux.

You can access these guides by opening the attached PDFs. Please go ahead and review the documents and follow the installation process to get everything set up on your computer. In subsequent lessons, we'll assume that these tools are installed and ready on your system.